



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

THE LIGHT OF THE QURAN

A Modern Companion to the Holy Quran Sharif

Volume V • Juz 8, 9 & 10 • Al-Anfal, At-Tawbah & Yunus

In the Blessed Tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

Battle of Badr • True Believers • Repentance • Yunus in the Whale • Divine Mercy

Designed for the Younger Generation of Muslims by Syed Yasir Ahmad

RECAP — VOLUMES I THROUGH IV

Volume	Juz	Surahs	Core Teaching
I	1	Al-Fatiha, Al-Baqarah (opening)	Faith, Adam (AS), Bani Israel, Ayat ul-Kursi
II	2-3	Al-Baqarah (close), Aal-e-Imran	Charity, Uhud, Maryam, Isa (AS), unity, Tawakkul
III	4-5	An-Nisa, Al-Ma'idah	Justice, women's rights, food laws, Islam completed
IV	6-7	Al-An'am, Al-A'raf	Tawheed proofs, Ibrahim's search, 6 Prophets, Covenant of Alast
V (this volume)	8-10	Al-Anfal, At-Tawbah, Yunus	Badr's victory, true Iman, Tawbah, mercy of Allah

'And whoever relies upon Allah — then He is sufficient for him. Indeed, Allah will accomplish His purpose. Allah has already set for everything a decreed extent.' — At-Talaq 65:3

SURAH 8 • JUZ 9

سُورَةُ الْأَنْفَالِ

AL-ANFAL — THE SPOILS OF WAR

The Surah of Badr • What True Faith Looks Like • When 313 Defeated 1,000

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Revelation: Madani — revealed immediately after the Battle of Badr (2 AH / 624 CE)**Number of Ayat:** 75 Verses**Named After:** Al-Anfal (the spoils/gains of war) — because the Companions asked who the war gains belong to**Context:** The Battle of Badr — the first major battle of Islam — 313 Muslims vs ~1,000 Quraysh warriors**Key Themes:** True Iman, unity of believers, trust in Allah in crisis, rules of war, treatment of prisoners, divine help**Famous Verses:** 8:2-4 (qualities of true believers), 8:9 (angels at Badr), 8:17 (it was Allah who struck, not you), 8:46 (do not dispute)**Core Message:** Victory belongs to those with true faith — not superior numbers or weapons

PART 1: THE PROFILE OF A TRUE BELIEVER — 8:2-4

The Quran's Most Precise Description of Genuine Faith

Surah Al-Anfal opens not with war strategy — but with a character portrait. Before describing the Battle of Badr, Allah defines what kind of people deserve His help. These four verses are one of the most precise definitions of true Iman in the entire Quran.

إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ الَّذِينَ إِذَا ذُكِرَ اللَّهُ وَجِلَتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ

"The true believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, their hearts tremble with awe." 8:2

The 5 Signs of True Iman (8:2-4):

1. When Allah is mentioned — hearts tremble: Not just knowing about Allah intellectually, but FEELING His greatness. The heart responds to His Name.

2. When His verses are recited — faith increases: Every time you hear Quran, something should grow in you. If it doesn't — check the state of your heart.

3. They rely upon their Lord alone (Tawakkul): In every challenge — the first place they turn is Allah. Not people, not plans — Allah first.

4. They establish Salah: Not just performing — establishing. Salah with presence, with understanding, as a pillar of daily life.

5. They spend from what We have provided them: Generosity is part of Iman. Holding wealth tightly while others suffer is a sign of weak faith.

Their Reward: Ranks with their Lord, forgiveness, and noble provision (8:4)

Sign of True Iman	What It Looks Like Today	What Its Absence Looks Like
Heart trembles at Allah's mention	Feeling moved when making du'a; eyes well up during recitation	Reciting Quran robotically with no emotion or presence
Faith increases with Quran	Each ayah adds certainty and motivation	Knowing the Quran but feeling no pull to act on it
Tawakkul — relying on Allah	Praying Istikhara before decisions; du'a before every action	Trusting only your own planning; anxiety when plans fail
Establishing Salah	Praying on time, with khushu, as the anchor of the day	Praying when 'convenient'; making up missed prayers casually
Spending from provisions	Regular Sadaqah; not hoarding; giving before being asked	Calculating exactly how little you must give; avoiding charity
🌸 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson): The Quran does not say 'the believers are those who CLAIM to believe.' It says those whose hearts TREMBLE. Faith is not a checkbox — it is a living, responsive relationship with the Divine. If you feel your heart has become hard — start with the smallest things: the Basmala before each action, a few moments of reflection after each Salah, one verse of Quran with its meaning each morning. Scholars teach that the heart is like land: neglected land grows weeds; tended land bears fruit. Even dry land can become fertile again with the water of sincere effort.		

PART 2: THE BATTLE OF BADR — WHEN FAITH DEFEATED FORCE

17th Ramadan, 2 AH (13th March 624 CE) — The Day of Criterion

✂ BATTLE ANALYSIS: The Numbers That Defied All Military Logic

Muslim Force: 313 men. Poorly armed — 70 camels shared among them, 2 horses, minimal armour. Many were former slaves, artisans, and merchants with no battle experience. Quraysh Force: Between 950-1,000 warriors. Fully armed, with horses, armour, and veteran fighters. They came to crush Islam once and for all. The location: the wells of Badr, a valley 150 km south-west of Madinah. By every military calculation, this should have been the annihilation of the young Muslim community. What happened next became a turning point in early Islamic history.

Phase	What Happened	Quranic Reference	Lesson
The Night Before	Prophet ﷺ spent the entire night in du'a, weeping: 'O Allah, if this group perishes today, You will not be worshipped on earth'	8:9	Du'a before action — the weapon of the believer
Divine Help Arrives	Allah sent 1,000 angels to fight alongside the Muslims — with Jibreel (AS) leading them	8:9, 3:124	When human means fail, divine means arrive for the sincere
Sleep and Rain as Gifts	Allah sent tranquil sleep upon the Muslims the night before, and rain that firmed the sand under their feet	8:11	Allah prepares the environment for those who trust Him
The Strike	'It was not you who struck — it was Allah who struck' — the Prophet ﷺ threw sand and Allah made it reach every enemy eye	8:17	Human action + divine power = miraculous results
The Victory	70 Quraysh killed, 70 captured. 14 Muslims martyred. Complete Muslim victory	8:19	Not numbers — Tawakkul and Taqwa determine victory
The Aftermath	The Quran revealed: how to treat prisoners; how to divide the spoils; what disunity costs	8:41, 8:67	Victory comes with responsibilities — not just celebration

إِذْ يُغَشِّيكُمُ النُّعَاسَ أَمَنَةً مِّنْهُ وَيُنْزِلُ عَلَيْكُمْ مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً

"When He covered you with drowsiness as security from Him and sent down upon you rain from the sky to purify you and remove the evil whispers of Shaytan from you." **8:11**

♦ MIRACLE: The Angel Army at Badr — A Historical Witness

Accounts from Companions describe seeing men in white, riding horses — striking the enemy — who were not among the Muslim ranks. One Companion narrated that he was pursuing a Quraysh warrior when the man suddenly fell — killed by an unseen strike — before he could reach him. The Quran confirms (8:12): 'I will cast terror into the hearts of those who disbelieved, so strike above their necks and strike their every fingertip.' The psychological terror that struck the Quraysh — despite their superior numbers — was itself a divine weapon. Modern military psychology acknowledges psychological factors are known to strongly affect outcomes in conflict. At Badr, this was divinely orchestrated.

❏ STORY: Sayyiduna Abu Bakr ❏ and the Night of Du'a

The night before Badr, as the Prophet ﷺ stood under a canopy making du'a with outstretched arms, Sayyiduna Abu Bakr ❏ — unable to bear watching the Prophet ﷺ plead so desperately — gently embraced him and said: 'O Messenger of Allah, enough — Allah will surely fulfil His promise to you.' The Prophet ﷺ emerged from the canopy with his cloak falling from his shoulders, reciting: 'The army will be defeated, and they will turn their backs in retreat. But the Hour is their appointed time, and the Hour will be most catastrophic and bitter.' (54:45-46). These verses had been revealed years earlier in Makkah, as a future prophecy. At Badr, they came true. This is why scholars say: the Battle of Badr was not won with swords — it was won the night before, with tears.

Rules of War Established at Badr — 8:58-61

Rule of War	Quranic Verse	Islamic Law	Modern International Law Parallel
No surprise attacks without warning	8:58 — 'If you fear treachery, throw their treaty back to them equally'	Cannot attack without declaring war	Modern international law includes regulations regarding declaration and conduct of war
Prisoners must be treated humanely	8:67-70 — 'Deal kindly with them'	Prisoners fed, clothed, ransomed — not tortured	Geneva Convention: POW rights
Cease if enemy seeks peace	8:61 — 'If they incline to peace, incline to it'	Peace is always preferred to continued war	UN Charter: obligation to seek peaceful resolution
No destruction of civilian property	Hadith — Abu Dawud	Crops, homes, places of worship protected	Hague Regulations on Laws of War
Division of spoils — structured	8:41 — 'A fifth belongs to Allah and the Messenger'	Khums system — prevents personal accumulation	No direct modern parallel

وَأَعِدُّوا لَهُمْ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ مِنْ قُوَّةٍ

"Prepare against them whatever force and cavalry you are able, to terrify the enemies of Allah and your enemies." 8:60

 SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: 8:60 — The Command to Prepare, Not to Attack

This verse — often quoted out of context — is a command to maintain defensive readiness, not aggressive expansion. The word 'Turhiboona' means 'to deter' — the same concept as modern military deterrence theory. Scholars unanimously explain that this verse is about maintaining enough strength that enemies do not dare to attack — not about seeking wars. The Prophet ﷺ himself spent far more time in peace negotiations and treaties than in battle. Of his 23-year mission, active military conflict occupied less than two years total.

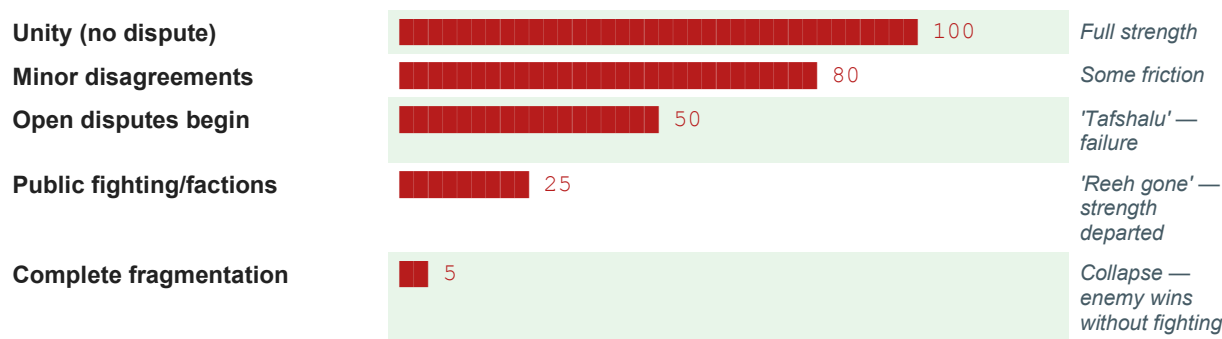
PART 3: THE GREATEST CAUSE OF DEFEAT — DISUNITY (8:46)

وَلَا تَنَازَعُوا فَتَفْشَلُوا وَتَذْهَبَ رِيحُكُمْ

"And do not dispute, for you will fail and your strength will depart." 8:46

Four Arabic words — 'wa la tanaza'u fa tafshalu wa tadhhaba reehukum' — contain the entire diagnosis of why Muslim communities, businesses, families, and nations fail. Dispute → failure → loss of strength. The chain is automatic. The Quran states it as a law of nature.

How Internal Dispute Weakens Communities — The Quranic Formula (illustrative)



The Lesson from Uhud Applied to 8:46:

At Uhud, the archers disputed among themselves about whether to stay at their post. The majority left. That dispute — lasting minutes — opened a gap that turned a Muslim victory into a catastrophic reversal. At Badr, the Muslims were unified under one command. At Uhud, they disputed. The difference between the two outcomes was not weapons or numbers. It was obedience and unity. Allah encoded this lesson in 8:46 so the Ummah would never forget it.

﴾ NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

8:46 applies to every Muslim home, organisation, and community today. The Muslim world's greatest enemy is not external — it is the internal dispute that fractures families, divides masjid committees, splits organisations, and paralyses communities. Scholars teach that in any disagreement, the first question to ask is not 'who is right?' but 'what does Allah want from this situation?' Often, what Allah wants is unity and mercy — even if that means making personal sacrifices of pride and position.

SURAH 9 • JUZ 10 & 11

سُورَةُ التَّوْبَةِ

AT-TAWBAH — THE REPENTANCE

The Surah Without Bismillah • The Exposer of Hypocrisy • The Companions Who Stayed Behind

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Revelation: Madani — among the very last Surahs revealed, approximately 9 AH, one year before the Prophet's ﷺ passing**Number of Ayat:** 129 Verses**Unique Feature:** The ONLY Surah without Bismillah at the start — scholars give several reasons for this distinction**Also Known As:** Al-Bara'ah (The Declaration of Disavowal), Al-Fadiha (The Exposer), Al-Muqashqisha (The Liberator from Hypocrisy)**Historical Context:** Revealed after the Tabuk expedition — when hypocrites made excuses and three sincere Companions stayed behind by mistake**Key Themes:** Disavowal of treaty-breakers, exposing hypocrites, the story of Ka'b ibn Malik ؓ, the pillars of community**Famous Verses:** 9:40 (Allah's help in the cave), 9:71 (believers as protectors of each other), 9:105 (deeds witnessed by Allah), 9:128-129 (final two verses of the Surah)

PART 4: WHY NO BISMILLAH? — ONE OF THE QURAN'S GREAT MYSTERIES

Every Surah of the Quran begins with Bismillah ir-Rahman ir-Raheem — except At-Tawbah. This has fascinated scholars for 1,400 years. Why would Allah omit His opening formula of mercy from this Surah?

Scholarly View	Explanation	Who Held This View
Declaration of disavowal, not mercy	Tawbah begins with a declaration of breaking treaties with those who betrayed Islam — Bismillah (mercy) is inappropriate for a declaration of war/disavowal	Imam Ali ؓ, narrated by Tirmidhi
Tawbah is a continuation of Al-Anfal	Some Companions considered them one Surah — which is why there is no Bismillah between them (you don't say Bismillah mid-Surah)	Ibn Abbas ؓ, majority scholarly view
The Prophet ﷺ passed before specifying	The Prophet ﷺ did not indicate whether Bismillah should be placed here — so the Companions left it as he had recited	Imam Ahmad, Imam Nawawi

Scholarly View	Explanation	Who Held This View
A deliberate divine choice for emphasis	The absence of 'In the Name of the Most Merciful' signals that this Surah deals with consequences — a wake-up call, not a mercy-opening	Some Sufi scholars

♦ MIRACLE: The Mathematical Miracle of Bismillah

The Quran has 114 Surahs and 113 Bismillahs (At-Tawbah has none, but Surah An-Naml 27:30 contains a Bismillah WITHIN the Surah — as part of the letter of Sulayman (AS)). $114 - 1 + 1 = 114$. The count is preserved. Furthermore, Surah An-Naml (27) and At-Tawbah (9) are exactly $27 + 9 = 36$ apart in Surah numbering, and their Bismillahs 'balance' each other in a way that some scholars of I'jaz al-Adadi (numerical miracles) find remarkable. The deliberate architecture of the Quran — maintained across 23 years of revelation — is seen by some as part of the remarkable structure of the Quran.

PART 5: 'DO NOT GRIEVE — ALLAH IS WITH US' — 9:40

The Most Personal Verse in the Quran

إِذْ يَقُولُ لِصَاحِبِهِ لَا تَحْزَنْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَنَا

"When he said to his companion: 'Do not grieve — indeed Allah is with us.'" 9:40

📖 STORY: The Cave of Thawr — Three Days That Changed History

The Hijra — the migration from Makkah to Madinah in 622 CE — was the most dangerous journey in Islamic history. The Quraysh had placed a bounty of 100 camels on the Prophet's ﷺ head — dead or alive. As the Prophet ﷺ and his closest companion Abu Bakr ﷺ slipped out of Makkah in the dead of night, they took refuge in the Cave of Thawr — a cave in the mountains south of Makkah. For three nights and days, they hid there as search parties scoured the area. At one point, the Quraysh reached the very entrance of the cave. Abu Bakr ﷺ whispered, trembling: 'O Messenger of Allah — if any of them looks down, they will see us.' The Prophet ﷺ replied with perfect, unshakeable calm: 'La tahzan — do not grieve. Inna Allaha ma'ana — Indeed Allah is with us.' And Allah sent a spider to spin its web across the cave entrance — and a dove to nest there. The search party saw the unbroken web and unfrightened dove and concluded no one could have entered recently. They turned away. The two most important men in Islamic history, hidden by a spider's thread and a bird's nest — protected by the One who made them.

Four Reasons This Verse is Among the Most Beloved in the Quran:

1. **'La tahzan' — Do not grieve:** A direct divine command to the human heart — stop the spiral of anxiety. This is spoken by the Prophet ﷺ, but the Quran enshrines it as Allah's own teaching.
2. **'Sahib' — His companion:** Allah calls Abu Bakr ﷺ the Prophet's 'Sahib' (companion) — the only Companion named in this way in the Quran. A divine honour embedded in the text.
3. **'Inna Allaha ma'ana' — Allah is WITH us:** Not 'near us', not 'watching us' — WITH us. Ma'iyyah — divine companionship — is the highest comfort imaginable.
4. **The result:** 'Then Allah sent down His tranquillity (Sakinah) upon him' (9:40) — divine peace that no human source can manufacture.

📌 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

The next time you face a moment of overwhelming fear — a diagnosis, a crisis, a dark night of the soul — return to these four Arabic words: 'La tahzan. Inna Allaha ma'ana.' Do not grieve. Allah is with us. These are not platitudes — they are the words that calmed the Prophet ﷺ's closest companion in the most dangerous moment of Islamic history. They have the same power today. Write them. Say them. Feel them. Let the Sakinah descend.

PART 6: BELIEVERS VS HYPOCRITES — THE DEFINITIVE CONTRAST (9:71-74)

وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتُ بَعْضُهُمْ أَوْلِيَاءُ بَعْضٍ

"The believing men and believing women are allies of one another." 9:71

Quality	True Believers (9:71)	Hypocrites (9:67-68)
Relationship to each other	Awliya — protectors, allies, friends of one another	'Some of them are like others' — a community of mutual enabling of wrong
What they command	Amr bil-Ma'ruf — commanding what is right	Munkar — commanding what is wrong/rejected
What they forbid	Nahy anil-Munkar — forbidding what is evil	Ma'ruf — forbidding what is good
Salah	Establish it — as a pillar of life	'They are lazy (kusala)' when they rise to pray
Zakah	Give it — generously	'They are reluctant' — tight-fisted
Obedience to Allah and Prophet ﷺ	'They obey Allah and His Messenger'	'They have forgotten Allah, so He has forgotten them'
Their Promise	Allah promises them Gardens — and His pleasure: 'That is the greatest success'	Hellfire — as their permanent abode

📖 SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: 'Awliya' — The True Meaning of Believer Brotherhood

The word 'Awliya' — used for believers in 9:71 — is the same word used for the Awliya Allah (Friends of Allah). Its root means: close ally, protector, one who takes responsibility for another. When the Quran says believing men and women are each other's Awliya, it is saying: you are responsible FOR each other. Not just politely coexisting — but actively protecting, supporting, commanding good and forbidding wrong together. This is the Islamic model of community: not a collection of isolated individuals who happen to share a faith — but a living organism where each part cares for every other. The Prophet ﷺ said: 'The believers in their mutual love, mercy, and compassion are like one body.' (Bukhari & Muslim)

PART 7: EVERY DEED IS WITNESSED — 9:105

وَقُلْ اَعْمَلُوا فَسَيَرَى اللّٰهُ عَمَلَكُمْ وَرَسُولُهُ وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ

"And say: Act! For Allah will see your deeds, and His Messenger, and the believers." 9:105

This verse is one of the most motivating and most sobering in the Quran. It tells us that our actions are not private. They are seen — by three witnesses: Allah Most High, the Prophet ﷺ, and the community of believers.

Three Witnesses to Every Action:

- 1. Allah sees:** 'Fa-sa-yarAllahu' — Allah will see. Nothing is hidden. The deed done in secret, the intention behind the public act, the quality of the heart in worship — all witnessed.
- 2. The Prophet ﷺ sees:** Scholars explain this in two ways: (a) the deeds of the Ummah are presented to the Prophet ﷺ — a position held by classical scholars; (b) his Sunnah is the standard against which all deeds are measured.
- 3. The believers will see:** On the Day of Judgment, the Ummah's record will be witnessed collectively. And in this world — your actions shape the community you live in. What you do echoes outward.

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Presentation of Deeds to the Prophet ﷺ

The position of many classical scholars — including Imam al-Busiri (author of Qasida al-Burda), Imam al-Suyuti, and others in the tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah — is that the deeds of the Ummah are presented to the Prophet ﷺ. They cite this verse (9:105) alongside the Hadith: 'My life is good for you — you relate (hadith) and it is related to you. And my death is good for you — your deeds are presented to me. Whatever good I see, I praise Allah for it. Whatever evil I see, I seek forgiveness for you.' (Bazzar, with a chain evaluated by scholars). This belief strengthens the Muslim's relationship with the Prophet ﷺ — knowing that he is aware of our state and intercedes for us.

🔗 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

9:105 ends: 'Then you will be returned to the Knower of the Unseen and the Witnessed, and He will inform you of what you used to do.' Every Thursday and Monday, according to authentic Hadith, deeds are presented to Allah. This is why the Prophet ﷺ fasted on those days. Think of this verse the next time you are about to do something you would be ashamed for others to see. Then ask: would I be ashamed for Allah and His Prophet ﷺ to see this? If yes — stop. If you are proud for them to see it — continue and increase.

PART 8: THE STORY OF KA'B IBN MALIK ﷺ — THE POWER OF TRUTH (9:118)

وَعَلَى الثَّلَاثَةِ الَّذِينَ خَلْفُوا حَتَّىٰ إِذَا ضَاقَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الْأَرْضُ بِمَا رَحُبَتْ

"And to the three who were left behind — until the earth, vast as it is, closed in on them, and their souls closed in on them." 9:118

STORY: Ka'b ibn Malik ﷺ — The Man Who Told the Truth and Was Forgiven by Allah

Ka'b ibn Malik ﷺ was one of the Ansar — a devoted Companion who had fought at Badr and Uhud. When the Prophet ﷺ called the Ummah to the Tabuk expedition (9 AH) — a gruelling march in extreme heat to the Syrian border — Ka'b had the means and the health to go. But he delayed. Then delayed again. And by the time he was ready, the army had left. He was one of three sincere Companions who stayed behind — not from hypocrisy, but from laziness and procrastination. When the Prophet ﷺ returned victorious, the hypocrites came with their excuses. But Ka'b stood before the Prophet ﷺ and said simply: 'I have no excuse. I had the ability to go, and I did not.' The Prophet ﷺ told him to wait for Allah's judgment. For fifty days, Ka'b and the other two were socially boycotted by the entire Muslim community — no one spoke to them, no one responded to their salaams. The earth itself felt tight. After fifty days of this agonising isolation — fifty days of sincere Tawbah and tears — Allah revealed 9:118: 'He turned in mercy to them so that they might turn (in repentance). Indeed, Allah is the Accepting of Repentance, the Merciful.' Ka'b ﷺ said: 'Nothing Allah ever blessed me with after Islam was greater than the fact that I told the truth to the Prophet ﷺ that day and was not destroyed with those who lied.' He lived until old age — and the Quran preserved his story for all of eternity.

Five Lessons from Ka'b ibn Malik ﷺ:

- 1. Truth in adversity is the greatest test:** When everyone around him was lying to save themselves, Ka'b chose the harder truth.
- 2. Sincere Tawbah has a process:** It was not instant. Fifty days of consequences, isolation, and genuine regret — THEN forgiveness came.
- 3. Allah records truthfulness forever:** Ka'b's truth — and his Tawbah — are embedded in the Quran until the Day of Judgment. Lies are forgotten; truth is immortalised.
- 4. Community consequences are real:** Islamic community accountability — temporary social boycott — was a tool of reform, not permanent exclusion.
- 5. The door of Tawbah always opens:** Fifty days feels like an eternity. But sincere repentance — without excuse-making — always reaches Allah.

SURAH 10 • JUZ 11

سُورَةُ يُونُسَ

YUNUS — JONAH

The Surah of Divine Mercy • The Prophet in the Whale • Faith at the Last Moment

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Revelation: Makki — revealed in Makkah, addressing the Quraysh's rejection of the Prophet ﷺ

Number of Ayat: 109 Verses

Named After: Yunus (Jonah) alayhis salam — though his story occupies only a few verses, his spirit of divine mercy pervades the Surah

Core Theme: Allah's infinite mercy; the reality of revelation; the lessons of Nuh (AS) and Musa (AS); the story of Yunus (AS)

Key Verses: 10:57-58 (the Quran as healing), 10:62-64 (the Friends of Allah), 10:87 (direction of prayer), 10:98 (Yunus's people — the only nation saved after seeing punishment)

The Mercy Surah: More than any other Surah, Yunus repeatedly emphasises that Allah's mercy encompasses all things — but must be sought

For the Questioner: Directly addresses those who ask: 'Why does Allah allow suffering?' 'Why don't miracles happen today?' 'Is the Quran really from God?'

PART 9: THE QURAN AS MEDICINE — 10:57

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ قَدْ جَاءَتْكُمْ مَوْعِظَةٌ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ وَشِفَاءٌ لِّمَا فِي الصُّدُورِ

"O mankind! There has come to you an instruction from your Lord and a healing for what is in the breasts — and guidance and mercy for the believers." **10:57**

The Quran describes itself here with four qualities — four things it IS, not just four things it contains. Understanding each one changes how we approach this Book.

Quranic Self-Description	Arabic Term	What It Means for Us	How to Receive It
Instruction / Admonition	Maw'idhah	A teaching that touches the heart — not just informs the mind	Read it with the intention of being changed, not just informed
Healing for the breast	Shifa' lima fis-sudur	Cure for spiritual diseases: grief, anxiety, arrogance, jealousy, hatred	Read it in times of distress — let it speak directly to your wound
Guidance	Huda	A light on the path — showing which direction to walk	Read it when facing decisions and crossroads in life

Quranic Self-Description	Arabic Term	What It Means for Us	How to Receive It
Mercy	Rahmah	Allah's grace that descends when the Quran is present	Read it knowing that by opening it, you have invited Allah's mercy in

♦ MIRACLE: The Quran and Mental Health — A Modern Rediscovery

A 2020 study published in the Journal of Religion and Health found that Muslims who regularly recited and reflected on the Quran showed significantly lower levels of depression, anxiety, and psychological distress — independent of socioeconomic factors. The rhythmic, melodic recitation of Arabic (even without full understanding) activates the parasympathetic nervous system. The meaning, when understood, provides cognitive reframing — replacing catastrophic thinking with divine perspective. The ritual of Wudhu before recitation is itself a mindfulness practice. Allah called the Quran 'Shifa' (healing) 1,400 years before clinical psychology existed — and modern research is confirming what believers have always known.

أَلَا إِنَّ أَوْلِيَاءَ اللَّهِ لَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ

"Verily, the Friends of Allah — no fear shall come upon them, nor shall they grieve." 10:62

Who Are the Awliya Allah? — 10:62-64 Explains:

Condition 1 — 'Alladhina amanu' — Those who believed: Iman is the foundation of Wilayah

Condition 2 — 'Wa kanu yattaqoon' — And they maintained Taqwa (God-consciousness in all affairs)

Their Reward — 'La khawfun alayhim wa la hum yahzanoon' — No fear and no grief. In this life: spiritual peace. In the next: perfect security.

The Promise — 'Lahum al-bushra fil-hayat id-dunya wa fil-akhira' — For them are glad tidings in the worldly life and in the Hereafter (10:64).

Scholars note that 10:62-64 defines the Awliya Allah (Friends/Saints of Allah) by Iman and Taqwa — not by miracles, lineage, or titles. Any believer with sincere faith and God-consciousness is a Wali of Allah. The great scholars and saints throughout Islamic history are Awliya because they exemplified these two qualities to the highest degree — and their spiritual inheritance (baraka) continues to benefit those who connect to them.

PART 10: YUNUS (AS) IN THE BELLY OF THE WHALE — HUMANITY'S DARKEST DU'A

The Story That Gives Every Trapped Soul Hope

📖 STORY: Sayyiduna Yunus (AS) — The Prophet Who Left Without Permission

Sayyiduna Yunus (Jonah) alayhis salam was sent to the city of Nineveh (modern-day Mosul, Iraq) — a great city of 100,000 people. He preached to them for years. When they refused and he saw no sign of change, he left — without waiting for Allah's permission to do so. He boarded a ship. A violent storm broke out. The sailors cast lots to determine who was the cause of the misfortune (an ancient custom) — and the lot fell to Yunus three times. He acknowledged the truth and had himself thrown overboard. A great whale (the Quran calls it 'al-Hut' — the fish/whale) swallowed him whole — not to destroy him, but to shelter him. In the darkness of the whale's belly, in the darkness of the deep ocean, in the darkness of night — Yunus (AS) cried out in du'a: 'La ilaha illa Anta, Subhanaka, Inni kuntu min adh-dhalimin' — There is no god but You, glorified are You — indeed I was among the wrongdoers. (21:87). Allah responded: 'And had he not been of those who glorify Allah, he would have remained in its belly until the Day of Resurrection.' (37:143-144). The whale carried Yunus to shore and ejected him. He was in a state of weakness — like a newborn. A gourd plant grew over him for shade and nutrition. Then Allah sent him back to Nineveh. And the people — seeing the signs of divine warning — believed. All of them. 100,000 souls saved by one Prophet's repentance and return.

فَنَادَى فِي الظُّلُمَاتِ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ سُبْحَانَكَ إِنِّي كُنْتُ مِنَ الظَّالِمِينَ

"And he called out within the darknesses: There is no deity except You; exalted are You. Indeed, I have been of the wrongdoers." 21:87

Du'a Yunus — The Most Powerful Du'a for Crisis:

لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ سُبْحَانَكَ إِنِّي كُنْتُ مِنَ الظَّالِمِينَ

La ilaha illa Anta, Subhanaka, Inni kuntu min adh-dhalimin

The Prophet ﷺ said: 'No Muslim ever supplicates with this du'a for anything except that Allah responds to him.' (Tirmidhi — Hasan). The three movements of this du'a: (1) Tawheed — 'No god but You'; (2) Tanzih — 'Glorified are You, above all imperfection'; (3) Tawbah — 'I was among the wrongdoers.' It acknowledges Allah's sovereignty, His perfection, and one's own fallibility — in a single breath. This is the du'a from the deepest darkness — the belly of a whale, the bottom of the sea, in the middle of the night. If it was answered there, it will be answered for you.

Lesson from Yunus (AS)	Detail	Application for Us
Even Prophets make mistakes	He left without divine permission — a lapse in patience	Our mistakes do not disqualify us from Allah's mercy or mission
Consequences are real	He was swallowed by a whale — his decision had real outcomes	Allah does not always remove natural consequences of our choices

Lesson from Yunus (AS)	Detail	Application for Us
Repentance works in any darkness	Du'a from inside a whale, under the sea, at night — still answered	No circumstance is too dark for sincere Tawbah to reach Allah
Return to mission after failure	He was sent BACK to Nineveh after his repentance	Allah restores and re-commissions those who return to Him
One person's Tawbah saved a city	His repentance led to the salvation of 100,000 people	Our spiritual state affects those around us — more than we know

♦ MIRACLE: The City of Nineveh — Archaeological Confirmation

Nineveh — the city Yunus (AS) was sent to — is one of the most excavated sites in the ancient world. Modern archaeologists have uncovered the ancient city at Kuyunjik near Mosul, Iraq. Assyrian records confirm it was indeed a great city — the capital of the Neo-Assyrian Empire at its peak (around the 8th century BCE). The Quran describes it as a city of 100,000 or more (37:147). Archaeological evidence confirms Nineveh's massive population and strategic importance. The Quran's description as a great city requiring a Prophet is historically verified. Remarkably, the tradition of 'Yum Ashura' fasting, which Muslims observe, is also linked by scholars to Musa (AS) — but connects to the broader theme of gratitude for divine rescue that runs through the Yunus story.

🌙 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

The Surah of Yunus is ultimately the Surah of mercy. Allah rescued a Prophet from inside a whale. He saved a city of 100,000 who saw the signs and believed. He sends the Quran as a healing for the deepest wounds of the human heart. The message: no one is beyond rescue. No darkness is too deep. No mistake too great. No wait too long. The same Allah who heard Yunus in the whale hears you in your room at 3am. Make the du'a. He is listening.

PART 11: FAITH AT THE LAST MOMENT — PHARAOH'S DEATH (10:90-92)

The Quran's Most Dramatic Account of Deathbed Repentance

حَتَّىٰ إِذَا أَذْرَكَهُ الْغَرَقُ قَالَ أَمِنْتُ أَنَّهُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا الَّذِي آمَنْتُ بِهِ بَنُو إِسْرَائِيلَ

"Until when drowning overtook him, he said: 'I believe that there is no god except the One in whom the Children of Israel believe, and I am of the Muslims.'" 10:90

ءَالُئِنْ وَقَدْ عَصَيْتَ قَبْلُ وَكُنْتَ مِنَ الْمُفْسِدِينَ

"Now? When you have been disobedient before and were of those who spread corruption?" 10:91

The Most Important Theological Lesson in Surah Yunus:

Pharaoh — who had claimed divinity, enslaved a nation, persecuted the Prophets, and rejected every miracle — declared faith at the LAST MOMENT of his life, as the waves of the sea closed over him. Allah's response was not mercy — it was: 'Now? After a lifetime of rejection and corruption?'

The scholars draw the critical distinction: there are TWO types of Tawbah.

Tawbah Maqboolah — Accepted Repentance: Repentance made BEFORE the moment of death is witnessed, while change is still possible — this is always accepted.

Tawbah Mardoodah — Rejected Repentance: Repentance at the moment of death — when one sees the angels of death — is not accepted, as per 4:18. Pharaoh's Tawbah came too late.

The preserved body of Pharaoh — confirmed by science:

Allah says in 10:92: 'So today We will save you in body, so that you may be a sign for those after you.' For 3,000 years, this was an unverifiable claim. Then in 1898, the mummified body of Ramesses II — widely identified as the Pharaoh of Moses — was discovered in Egypt and is now on display in the Cairo Museum. His body has been perfectly preserved. Scientists examined it in 1975 and found evidence of a violent death — consistent with drowning — and traces of sea salt on the remains. The Quran's promise was kept. The body is a sign.

JUZ 8, 9 & 10 — COMPLETE LESSONS SUMMARY

Major Themes Across Juz 8-10 (Weight of Content)

Battle of Badr — Analysis	40	Al-Anfal
True vs False Believers	35	Al-Anfal & At-Tawbah
Unity vs Disunity	20	Al-Anfal 8:46
No Bismillah — Mystery	10	At-Tawbah
Cave of Thawr — 9:40	15	At-Tawbah
Deeds Witnessed — 9:105	15	At-Tawbah
Ka'b's Story — Truth & Tawbah	20	At-Tawbah 9:118
Quran as Healing — 10:57	20	Yunus
Awliya Allah — 10:62-64	15	Yunus
Du'a Yunus — Greatest Crisis Du'a	25	Yunus 21:87
Pharaoh's Last Moment	20	Yunus 10:90-92

Golden Lesson	Source	One-Line Summary
True Iman lives in the heart — not just on the tongue	Al-Anfal 8:2-4	Five signs. Check yourself against them.
313 defeated 1,000 — because of faith and du'a	Al-Anfal — Badr	Allah's help comes to the sincere, not the strong
Dispute destroys strength automatically	Al-Anfal 8:46	Unity is not optional — it is survival
Do not grieve — Allah is with us	At-Tawbah 9:40	The ultimate comfort for the ultimate crisis
Allah witnesses every deed — and so does the Prophet ﷺ	At-Tawbah 9:105	Act as if being watched — because you are
Truth in adversity is the highest test	Ka'b ibn Malik □	Lies save you now; truth saves you forever
The Quran is your healing — receive it as medicine	Yunus 10:57	Four qualities: instruction, healing, guidance, mercy
No darkness is too deep for Allah's mercy	Yunus (AS) in the whale	Make Du'a Yunus — it was answered from the bottom of the sea
Tawbah must come before death is witnessed	Pharaoh's last moment	Don't wait for the waves to be above your head
The Friends of Allah are defined by Iman + Taqwa	Yunus 10:62-64	Any sincere believer can be a Wali of Allah

Reflection Questions — Juz 8, 9 & 10



Question	Verse	Action This Week
Do I feel my heart tremble when Allah is mentioned?	8:2	Sit in silence after Salah — just be with Allah for 2 minutes
Is my community unified or fragmented by disputes?	8:46	Identify one dispute you can help resolve this month
When was the last time I said 'La tahzan — Allah is with me'?	9:40	Write it on your wall. Say it every morning.
Do I act differently when no one is watching?	9:105	Choose one deed today to do purely for Allah
Am I using the Quran as healing — or just recitation?	10:57	Read one ayah with its meaning when feeling low this week
Have I made Du'a Yunus in my hardest moments?	21:87	Memorise it. Use it. It is the du'a for every whale.



لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ سُبْحَانَكَ إِنِّي كُنْتُ مِنَ الظَّالِمِينَ

La ilaha illa Anta, Subhanaka, Inni kuntu min adh-dhalimin

'There is no god but You, glorified are You — indeed I was among the wrongdoers.'

— Du'a of Yunus (AS) from the belly of the whale (21:87)

Volume VI — Juz 11 & 12: Surah Hud, Yusuf & Ar-Ra'd

Prophet Hud (AS) • The Full Story of Yusuf (AS) — The Most Beautiful Story • Lightning & Thunder

Compiled with love for the Ummah of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ

In the blessed tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

Sallallahu alayhi wa aalihi wa sahbihi wa sallam